

Phishing Awareness Analysis Report

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Introduction

Phishing is a form of cyber-attack that involves the attacker posing as a trusted organization to trick people into providing their personal information, like their banking details, passwords or other personal data.

Example 1: Fake Bank Email

Sample Message

Dear Customer,

Your bank account has been temporarily suspended for the following reasons:

Please click here right away to check your account:

www.hbl-secure-login.xyz

If not within 24 hours, then the account will be permanently closed.

Red Flags Found

- Fails to inform of any other choices
- Suspicious website link (.xyz domain)
- No salutation (no greeting at all)
- Threatening language
- Prompts user to click on an unknown link

Why It Is Unsafe

This message is an attempt at inducing fear in the user so that he/she clicks a fake site. Once the victim inputs the information, the attackers can gain access to the victim's banking details.

Example 2: Fake Prize Winning Message

Sample Message

Congratulations!

You've won an iPhone 18 Pro Max!

Enter your CNIC & Bank particulars to claim your reward now!

Visit: www.freegift-win.net

Red Flags Found

- Unexpected prize offer
- Asks for personal data (CNIC, bank information)
- Suspicious website
- Too-good-to-be-true offer

Why It Is Unsafe

Impersonating rewards by deceiving users to provide personal data that can be used for fraudulent purposes.

Example 3: Fake University Email

Sample Message

Dear Student,

The username and/or password for your university portal is outdated.

Click on the login link provided here, immediately: university-login-reset.ru.

Red Flags Found

- Unknown domain (.ru)
- Creates urgency
- Requests login credentials
- May use University website design to some extent

Why It Is Unsafe

Students are to be tricked into entering information on their academic accounts to steal them.

General Phishing Indicators Checklist

Common warning signs:

- Urgent messages
- Grammar mistakes
- Suspicious links
- Unknown sender address

- Asks for passwords, OTPs
- Rewards or prizes that are fake or bogus
- Threatening language
- Attachments from unknown senders

Conclusion

Phishing attacks exploit the human factor, not technical vulnerabilities. Before disclosing personal information in emails, links and requests users should be careful. One of the best lines of defense against cyber attacks is awareness.